



Install Selenium WebDriver and Enjoy the Advantages

The addition of a Web driver API to Selenium 2.0 has enabled it to provide a simpler, more concise programming interface in addition to addressing some limitations in the Selenium-RC API. This article takes the reader through the installation of Selenium WebDriver, covering the commands, supported drivers and a sample script.

Selenium WebDriver is the successor to Selenium RC, or we can say that Selenium 1.0 + WebDriver = Selenium 2.0. It provides a simple interface, supports dynamic Web pages, supplies a well-designed object-oriented API, etc.

Simon Stewart is the inventor of WebDriver. Selenium WebDriver is fully implemented and supported in Java, Ruby, Python and C#. It programmatically controls the browser. Using WebDriver, script browsers can be programmed.

Installing Selenium WebDriver

1. Install the latest version of Java
2. Download Eclipse IDE for Java developers from <http://www.eclipse.org/downloads/>
3. Download Selenium Java driver from <http://docs.seleniumhq.org/download/>

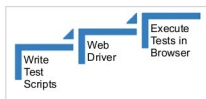


Figure 1: How to use Selenium WebDriver

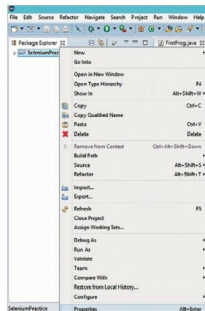


Figure 2: Configure Eclipse with WebDriver

4. Configure WebDriver with Eclipse IDE by going through the following steps:
 - Launch *eclipse.exe*
 - Set the workspace
 - Create a Java project using *File->New->Java project* in the Eclipse IDE
 - Create a Class in the Java project by right-clicking on it, and select *New-Class*
 - Now, add Selenium WebDriver in the Java build path
 - Select the project created in the above steps, right-click on it and select the *Properties* option

In the *Properties* window, click on *Java Build Path->Add External Jars*

- This will open the window depicted in Figure 4.

Table 1

Elements	Command
By ID	<code>driver.findElement(By.id("element_id"))</code>
By class	<code>driver.findElement(By.className("element class"))</code>
By name	<code>driver.findElement(By.name("element name"))</code>
By CSS selector	<code>driver.findElement(By.cssSelector("css selector"))</code>
By tag name	<code>driver.findElement(By.tagName("element html tag name"))</code>
By link	<code>driver.findElement(By.linkText("link text"))</code>
By partial link	<code>driver.findElement(By.partialLinkText("partial link text"))</code>
By XPath	<code>driver.findElement(By.xpath("xpath expression"))</code>